

Michael Susz

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Senior Frontend Engineer • Design Systems & Accessibility

Front-end engineer with 30 years of experience building scalable, accessible product interfaces at companies including IBM, Optum, Washington Mutual, and Intuit. Specializes in design systems, component architecture, and accessibility — with recent focus on AI-augmented development workflows including MCP server creation and Claude API integration. Passionate about building systems that make users happy and other developers more productive.

Core Competencies

Front-End Architecture & UX: Design Systems Integration & Governance · Component Architecture & Pattern Libraries · Accessibility (WCAG, Sec. 508, ARIA) · Front-End Modernization & Migration · UI Performance Engineering

Technical Skills Frameworks: React, Svelte, Next.js · Languages: JavaScript, TypeScript, HTML5, CSS3/Sass · Tooling: Storybook, Vite, GitHub, Jest/RTL · Cloud: AWS, Azure, IBM Cloud · Design: Figma · AI Workflow: MCP server development, Claude API, Playwright, local LLMs (Ollama/Qwen), Python

Professional Experience

IBM CONSULTING - Senior Front-End Developer / UX Systems Engineer

2021 – 2026

Lead front-end engineer and architectural contributor across government and enterprise modernization programs. Defined component strategy, design system integration, and accessibility compliance across multiple engagements; mentored developers on modern JavaScript patterns and best practices.

- Architected scalable React and Svelte applications for large-scale enterprise clients, emphasizing performance, long-term maintainability, and design system fidelity.
- Led accessibility strategy across multiple engagements, ensuring WCAG 2.1 / Section 508 compliance and guiding teams on ARIA patterns, semantic structure, and inclusive design.
- Built and shipped production MCP server integrations extending AI assistant capabilities — tools for knowledge management, content archiving, and automated workflow orchestration. Developed AI-accelerated prototyping workflows using Claude API, Playwright, and local LLMs.
- Stack: JavaScript, TypeScript, CSS, React, Svelte, MCP/Claude API, Playwright

IBM SOFTWARE / THE WEATHER COMPANY - SENIOR FRONT-END ENGINEER

2017 – 2021

Product-focused front-end engineer on enterprise weather intelligence tools used by utilities, emergency managers, and commercial customers at scale.

- Led front-end development of IBM Outage Prediction tooling using an iterative, research-driven process — observing customer workflows, incorporating feedback rapidly, and shipping improvements that directly reduced time-to-decision for weather event response.
- Designed and built a historical storm analog feature: a pattern-matching system that surfaced the most similar historical events alongside each forecast. Became one of the product's most-used features.
- Engineered modular, performant UI components for high-availability enterprise products serving customers across utilities, media, and emergency management.
- Stack: JavaScript, Sass, React, Redux-Saga, IBM Carbon Design System

OPTUM TECHNOLOGIES / UNITED HEALTH GROUP - SENIOR FRONT-END DEVELOPER 2014 – 2017

Front-end lead for enterprise healthcare applications serving millions of members and thousands of providers.

- Built consumer-facing tools helping members find, vet, and select healthcare plans and services — high-stakes UX where clarity and accessibility directly impacted real healthcare decisions.
- Researched and redesigned a provider data management portal around the mental model of power users: data-entry specialists who thought in spreadsheets. Delivered keyboard-driven navigation, enter-to-save, inline numeric inputs instead of select lists, measurably reducing friction for users.
- Championed accessibility and component-driven architecture using Angular and Adobe Experience Manager across multiple product lines.
- Stack: HTML, CSS, Sass, Angular 1, Adobe Experience Manager

SQUAREDESIGN - UI ENGINEER AND CMS CONSULTANT**2007 – 2014**

Independent front-end consultant and UI engineer. Built a reputation among backend-focused development shops as the go-to specialist for technically demanding HTML, CSS, and front-end animation work, resulting in consistent subcontracted engagements across multiple agency partners.

- Built and shipped Evernote's in-app announcements system end-to-end: CMS authoring layer in WordPress (familiar to Evernote's editorial team), custom filtering logic targeting articles by language, region, dialect, product, and subscription tier, and embedded webview UI delivered to millions of users across Evernote's client apps.
- Built SpringPad's marketing website — full front-end implementation for a consumer product competing directly with Pinterest at the height of the social bookmarking era.
- Developed reusable component libraries and custom CMS implementations for agency partners serving clients including Sony, Fidelity, Monster.com, Philips, Kronos, and Harvard Pilgrim.
- Stack: HTML, CSS, Sass, JavaScript (animation-focused), WordPress

WASHINGTON MUTUAL - SENIOR UI DEVELOPER**2002 – 2007**

Front-end specialist and accessibility lead for consumer banking applications serving millions of customers.

- Joined as the HTML/CSS specialist on a team of ASP.NET and backend engineers — brought in for technically demanding front-end work including cross-browser layouts, semantic markup, and early interactive UI patterns.
- Spent years as the accessibility squeaky wheel — identifying WCAG and Section 508 issues and advocating for fixes. When an impending legal judgment against WaMu's core websites made accessibility impossible to ignore, became the accessibility subject matter expert across the organization.
- Partnered with designers and UX researchers to build a pattern library of accessible, reusable UI components — defining the HTML/CSS layer in a three-way collaboration with design and ASP.NET engineering.
- Stack: HTML, CSS, semantic markup (partnered with ASP.NET backend team)

INTUIT — USER-CENTERED DESIGN (UCD) - FRONT-END ENGINEER**2000 – 2001**

Front-end engineer embedded in the UCD organization building consumer financial products.

- Led front-end development of QuickBooks Site Solutions — a small business website builder delivered as an embedded webview within QuickBooks. Spent nearly a year in full iterative product development: sketches, paper prototyping, low-fidelity builds, and tested production implementation.
- Contributed front-end work to early QuickBase marketing, one of the first web-based relational database products, still in use today.
- Stack: DHTML, CSS, JavaScript

Career began as Webmaster, Wentworth Institute of Technology (1996)